

India produces world-class coders, yet its own laws often leave them without defensible intellectual property. The result is predictable. Investors hesitate, startups migrate filing to other jurisdictions, and India remains an outsourcing hub instead of an intellectual property leader.

## A framework for national alignment

Economic leadership is a system design problem.

1. Education builds talent.
2. Innovation converts talent into industries.
3. Industry generates wealth and jobs.
4. Governance ensures fairness

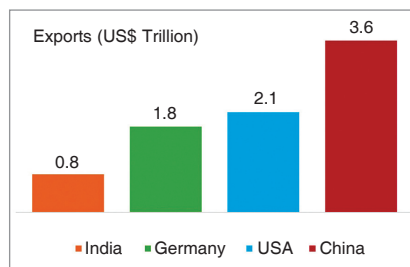


Fig. 3: Exports and manufacturing share, 2023 (Sources: World Bank's World Development Indicators, the World Trade Organisation statistics Database, and the UN Comtrade Database, 2023)

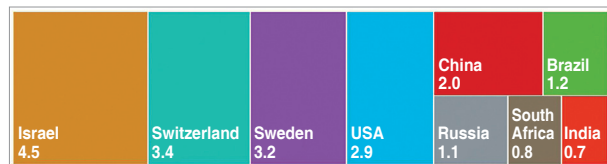


Fig. 4: Percentage of GDP spend on R&D (Source: NITI Ayog)

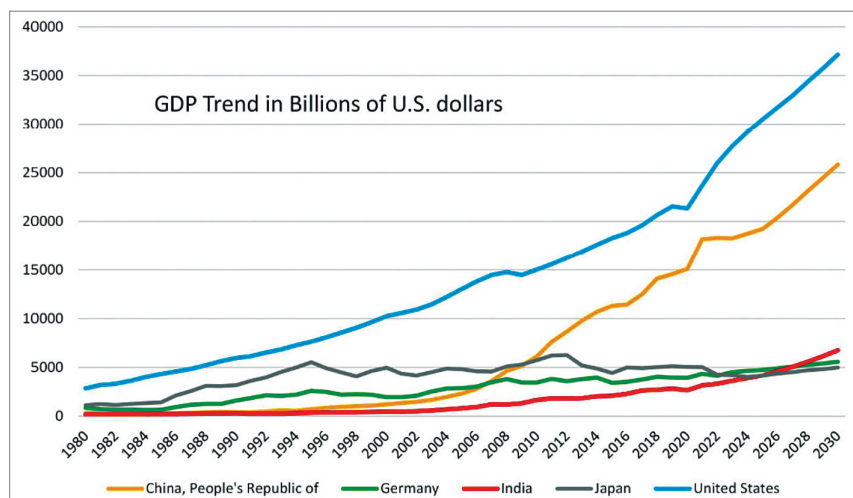


Fig. 5: GDP trend in billions of US dollars (Source: IMF World Economic Outlook)

TABLE 2  
COMPETITIVENESS AND GOVERNANCE INDICATORS

| Indicator (latest)             | India | China | USA  | Singapore (best practice) |
|--------------------------------|-------|-------|------|---------------------------|
| Ease of Doing Business (2020)* | 63rd  | 31st  | 6th  | 2nd                       |
| Competitiveness Index (2019)   | 40th  | 28th  | 2nd  | 1st                       |
| Corruption Perception (2023)   | 93rd  | 80th  | 24th | 5th                       |

(Sources: World Bank, WEF Global Competitiveness Report, Transparency International CPI 2023)

\*Last full update before discontinuation; directionally valid

and stability.

5. Sovereignty protects independence and influence.

**Idea one.** Set measurable national milestones: universal foundational literacy by 2030, higher-education enrolment above 45-55%, stronger STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics) participation, and a clear pathway for software and algorithm-enabled patents.

**Idea two.** Build sovereign capability where dependence is dangerous.

**Semiconductors.** From materials research and equipment to packaging and design

**Compute and storage.** Green data centres integrated with renewable power and grid scale storage

**Power electronics.** High-efficiency inverters, converters, and chargers designed and built in India

**Defence AI.** Satellite intelligence, border surveillance, secure communications, and decision

support built on Indian platforms

**Health and agriculture AI.**

Diagnostics, disease surveillance, crop and water intelligence tuned to Indian languages and conditions

**Idea three.** Integrity is an economic multiplier.

Digitise approvals and licensing with audit trails. Protect whistleblowers. Publish transparent procurement dashboards. Enforce timely government payments to MSMEs.

## Strategic case for #1 economy

In a century defined by technology, India cannot remain an adopter of other people's platforms and standards. It must build its own. Leadership provides resources to protect borders, invest in fundamental research, and influence trade and technology rules.

## Vision for 2040

By 2040, leadership depends on four outcomes.

- Educate with confidence, fear-free
- Protect innovators with law and patient capital
- Power industries with reliable infrastructure
- Clean, predictable governance

## Closing note

This is not optimism by habit. It is confidence by design. India already has proof points at scale in digital identity and payments, in space and pharmaceuticals, and in the grit of its entrepreneurs. Our task is alignment—classrooms with laboratories, laboratories with factories, factories with markets, and markets with clean rules. If we do this with focus and urgency, India will not only read the rules of the twenty-first century, it will help write them. **EFY**